

Talent is Telangana's Greatest Advantage

D. Sridhar Babu, Minister for Information Technology, Electronics, Communications, Industries & Commerce and Legislative Affairs, Telangana, on the state's manufacturing prowess, its position as a global GCC hub, and more

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AS INDIA CHARTS its journey towards becoming a developed economy by 2047, Telangana is betting on technology, talent and innovation to emerge as a global manufacturing hub. Telangana has been the state to look out for in terms of exports, showing the fastest growth amongst emerging states in the period between FY18 to FY25 when it reported a 191% jump in the seven-year period. Even in the five years between FY20 to FY25, it logged the fastest growth amongst emerging states of 160% in exports, according to the *Business Today* study.

In an interview with *Business Today*, Telangana's



Minister for Information Technology, Electronics, Communications, Industries & Commerce and Legislative Affairs, D. Sridhar Babu, outlines the state's vision for AI-led manufacturing, semiconductors, global capability centres (GCCs), sustainability, and why he believes governments must enable innovation rather than merely regulate it. Edited excerpts:



Telangana has built a strong reputation in IT, pharmaceuticals, and life sciences. How do you plan to translate that strength into becoming a leading manufacturing destination by 2047?

As I often say, India cannot afford to export the flour and import the bread. We must create value here at home. That is why I do not see this as a choice between IT, life sciences, and manufacturing. I see it as the natural evolution of Telangana's growth story.

PHOTOS BY ASHUTOSH ASHOK PATWARDHAN